

The Medicube carousel: what worked, and the two things to add

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Bailey, you posted the Medicube neck cream carousel today and I want to give you a real read on it, not a pat on the head.

Short version: **the hard part is the part you got right**. The judgment in that post is better than most of what full time skincare creators put out. What is missing is the easy part, and it is genuinely two lines of text.

1. What you got right

This is not a warm up before the criticism. These are the things that cannot be taught, and you did all of them without being told.

You picked the perfect product to talk about

A viral Medicube ad, a #1 Best Seller badge, 20K buyers in a month. That is exactly the situation where people feel the pull hardest and have the least information. You did not pick an easy target.

You steelmanned it before you knocked it down

This is the whole thing. You let Yuri say the formula is genuinely good. Volufiline, retinol, niacinamide, PDRN, the peptide stack. She even says it is “more active than half your current shelf.”

Most people who make “don’t buy this” content just trash the product. Trashing it is weaker, because viewers can tell when someone is being unfair, and the moment they smell it they stop believing you. Admitting the thing is good and *still* saying skip it is far more convincing. That is the version people actually trust.

You offered no alternative product

This is the one I want to underline, because it is rare and it is the reason this post has teeth.

Almost all “don’t buy that” content on TikTok is really “don’t buy that, buy THIS instead.” Audiences figured that out a while ago, and now it reads as an ad wearing a costume. Your post never pivots to a recommendation. You just say save your money and stop.

Nobody can co-opt that, because there is nothing in it for anyone.

The receipts are the part no competitor can fake

Look at what Yuri actually said:

“that’s exactly the film forming, congestion trapping texture we just spent two weeks pulling out of your routine”

“you’re mid barrier recovery pause from the pool day flakiness”

That is not generic skincare advice. That is an AI that remembers your last two weeks and uses them to answer a new question. No other app on the market does that, and it is sitting right there in your screenshot doing it.

And the writing landed

“the built in applicator is the marketing, not the medicine”

That line is a keeper. Honestly it is good enough to be the opening line of a video by itself.

You also stayed on the right side of both hard rules

No Shop tag anywhere near a Seoul Sister mention. No symptom checklist, no telling people how to diagnose themselves. No dashes in the caption. Clean.

2. The two things to add next time

Both of these are small. Neither is about the substance, because the substance is good.

Thing one: nobody watching learns an AI exists

This is the big one.

The app is never named in your caption. “Seoul Sister” appears only as a small logo at the top of a dark screenshot, and the AI is never mentioned at all.

So put yourself in the shoes of someone who reads all four slides. They finish thinking... what, exactly? That you screenshotted a text from a friend? A message from your dermatologist? ChatGPT?

The single most interesting fact about that post is never stated anywhere in it. The fact is: *an AI that remembers your routine talked you out of a purchase you wanted to make.* That is the whole story. That is what makes someone stop and go “wait, what is that?”

Right now they have no way to know it happened, and no way to find it.

Thing two: slide 1 is doing none of the work

Your slides 3 and 4 are excellent. Slide 1 is what decides whether anyone ever sees them.

On a carousel, slide 1 is the thumbnail in the feed. It is the entire audition.

Right now slide 1 says:

“Are you SURE you want to buy another product just because it’s viral?!!”

The problem is not that it is badly written. The problem is that TikTok has approximately ten thousand soft lit beige posts asking that exact question, and viewers have learned to scroll past them. Nothing about it hints at the genuinely unusual thing sitting two slides later.

Compare it to this:

“I asked my AI skincare advisor if I should buy the viral Medicube neck cream. It said no.”

That does three jobs at once. It tells them something surprising exists, it makes them want to know what the AI said, and it sets up slides 3 and 4 to actually pay off instead of confuse.

Same post. Same screenshots. One different sentence on the front.

3. The caption fix, which handles the legal bit too

One line added to your caption solves the naming problem and a legal requirement at the same time.

Something like:

The AI is called Yuri. I co-created it with my dad. seoulsister.com/tt if you want her to read your routine like that.

Put it **above** the “more” cut, so it is visible without anyone tapping to expand.

Why the disclosure part is not optional

I am going to be direct about this one because it is the only thing in this document with actual legal weight.

You are an owner of the thing you were showing. The FTC calls that a material connection, and it has to be disclosed clearly, in the post itself and above the caption fold. Hashtags do not count. It does not matter how small the benefit is.

This is not about the post looking too salesy. It is the opposite. Disclosing early is protective. The scenario you want to avoid is someone in your comments working it out on their own and asking “wait, isn’t this your dad’s app?” Being asked is much worse than having said it up front, because then it looks like something you were hiding rather than something you were proud of.

And you have the good version of this. You are not a paid promoter reading a script. You built the thing, you use it every day, and you are the person who tells them when it is broken. That is a better story than any disclosure you would be hiding.

4. Please do not redo this one

Leave the post up as it is.

Two reasons.

It is too early to judge. Zero likes at four minutes old is not data, it is just four minutes. Posts get judged over days, and the whole strategy gets judged on the occasional one that takes off, never on individual averages.

Do not re upload a fixed version. This is the re upload thing I sent you the writeup about on Sunday. TikTok specifically enforces against re posting your own content, and it is not worth the risk on your account. If you want to run the idea again with a better opening slide, make it a **new post with a different angle**, not the same one again.

5. About the carousel format

Worth saying clearly: **using a carousel here was a reasonable call, and I never gave you any guidance about carousels.** Every script I wrote for you assumes video. That gap is mine, not yours.

The instinct is actually sound. Dense screenshot text is one of the few things carousels genuinely do better than video, because people will happily read a screenshot they would never pause a video to read. Your slides 3 and 4 are exactly the kind of content that works.

Two things to carry over:

The hook rule does not change. Whatever the format, the first thing has to earn the second thing. On video that is the first three seconds. On a carousel it is slide 1.

Do not let slide 1 be a pretty photo with text on it. That is very close to the beige text card problem that was killing the brand account's reach. The difference between a carousel that works and one that dies is entirely in whether slide 1 gives someone a reason to swipe.

6. The whole thing on one page

Keep doing:

- Steelmanning a product before you say skip it
- Never offering a replacement product
- Screenshots where Yuri references your actual history
- Picking genuinely viral products people are actively being sold

Add:

- Say the AI exists, in the caption, by name
- Say you co created it, above the “more” cut
- Make slide 1 or the first three seconds carry the surprise, not a generic question
- Drop the link when it fits naturally

One sentence version: you are nailing the part nobody can teach and skipping the part that takes ten seconds. Add the ten seconds.

That post had the best substance of anything on the account. I would rather give you real notes than tell you it was great and leave you wondering why nothing came of it.

Tell me if any of this reads wrong to you. You have been right before.